

Shortcuts in Google Chat

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What are shortcuts in Google Chat?

Imagine this: You're in an important meeting. Suddenly, you need to quickly locate a discussion you had yesterday with your team about the Project Phoenix launch. You may not remember everyone who was in the chat, but you know it happened. Does this seem familiar?

Key Challenge: Sifting through countless conversations to find what you need can be time-consuming, especially when you're under pressure.

Luckily, Google Chat offers a set of shortcuts designed to help you identify the conversations that matter most, right when you need them.

The shortcuts menu in Google Chat is your quick access points to specific categories of conversations and messages. They gather recent discussions, messages where you were directly mentioned, and items you've starred—all in one convenient place. This makes it faster and easier to find the message you need and respond.

Exploring your shortcuts

Home: Your recent activity feed

Think of the **Home** shortcut as your chronological timeline of recent activity in Google Chat.

To access your recent messages, begin by opening Google Chat. Then, in the **Shortcuts** section of the main menu, click **Home**.

Here, you'll find:

- Your recent messages from **individual conversations**.
- Activity from **group conversations**.
- Updates from **spaces** you're a part of.
- All organized in **chronological order**, with the newest messages at the top.

Let's revisit our scenario: Since your project discussion happened yesterday, it's likely to appear near the top of your **Home** view. Just scan the list for keywords or familiar participants.

Quick Tip: Need to focus only on what you haven't seen yet? Click **Unread** (often located at the top of the **Home** view) to filter out messages you've already read.

Engaging with Messages in the Home View

When you find the conversation you're looking for in the **Home** view, you can:

- **Open the message in a pop-up window:** Click the message to view the full thread and respond.
- **Mark as Read or Unread:** Quickly manage your message status.
- **Mute or Adjust Notifications:** Control how you're alerted to activity in less critical conversations.
- **Leave or Block:** Manage your participation in ongoing discussions, whether they are individual messages, group chats, or conversations in spaces.

Mentions: Find the messages that require your attention

The **Mentions** shortcut is your personal notification center, specifically for messages where someone has used @yourname to directly address you.

To access your mentions, in the **Shortcuts** section of the main menu, click **Mentions**. This shortcut ensures you don't miss important messages that require your direct input or awareness. By quickly accessing your mentions, you can efficiently address the communications that are most relevant to you and manage your time effectively.

Starred: Your collection of important messages

The **Starred** shortcut allows you to curate a collection of messages you've marked as important for later reference.

You can star a message to:

- **Save it for later reference:** You might need to revisit specific instructions, decisions, or pieces of information.
- **Mark as important:** Flag messages that require follow-up or hold significant value.
- **Make it easier to find:** Quickly access crucial information without having to search through entire conversations.

How to star a message:

1. Open the **conversation or space** containing the message you want to star.
2. **Hover your mouse** over the message, select **More actions** (usually an icon with three vertical dots), then choose **Star**.
3. A star icon will appear next to the message, indicating that it has been starred.
4. To find all of your starred messages, navigate to the **Shortcuts** section of the Main Menu, then select **Starred**.

Quick Tip: Starring messages saves individual messages for later review. To keep important chat conversations easily accessible, you can pin the conversation or space.

Putting it all together

Remember our initial scenario? By understanding the **Home** shortcut, you can quickly scan your recent conversations to likely find your Project Phoenix discussion from yesterday. If you had been specifically mentioned in that chat, the **Mentions** shortcut would also lead you right to it. And if there were key decisions or information shared in that conversation that you wanted to remember, starring those messages would make them easily accessible via the **Starred** shortcut.

Try it out yourself

Now that you know about Google Chat shortcuts, take a moment to open Google Chat and explore the **Home**, **Mentions**, and **Starred** sections. Review recent messages, find your mentions, and star a few messages. You'll quickly discover how these simple tools can significantly improve your efficiency and help you stay on top of your conversations!